

Trump Makes a Deal to Buy Russian Diesel to Lower Fuel Prices

From: BBC News Mined: 2026-10-09 5 min read

President Donald Trump has announced a deal to bring Russian **diesel** fuel into the United States. He says the plan should help bring down high fuel prices, but Ukraine's president strongly disagrees with it.

Diesel is a fuel used by trucks, trains, farm machines and many other vehicles. In recent months, the price of gasoline and especially **diesel** has jumped in America. The BBC reports that this is linked to a war involving Iran that began in February and has affected energy prices around the world. Higher fuel prices have also made many other things cost more.

On Friday, Trump said Russian President Vladimir Putin had agreed to release 300,000 **tonnes** of **diesel** right away, then 500,000 **tonnes** in November and another million **tonnes** after that. Trump said more could follow later. The US Treasury issued a temporary **license** allowing Russian **diesel** into the market and is pausing some **sanctions**, which are penalties on trade, until April 7.

Putin said Russia was willing to supply oil products to the US and other countries, but he did not give amounts.

Some experts doubt the plan will help much. One investment expert, Tim Armitage, said the first delivery was "relatively small" compared with how much **diesel** Americans use each day, so it would not make a big difference at the gas pump. He called it a "slightly desperate move" before next month's **midterm elections**.

Ukraine has been fighting against Russia's **invasion**. Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky called the deal a gift to Putin and said such gifts "will not work for peace." The United Kingdom said it would keep up its pressure on Russia and keep supporting Ukraine.

Word Treasure

diesel -- A heavy fuel used by trucks, trains and farm machines.

sanctions -- Penalties one country puts on another, often limits on trade, to pressure it to change.

tonnes -- Metric tons; one tonne equals 1,000 kilograms, or about 2,205 pounds.

license -- Official permission from the government to do something.

midterm elections -- US elections held halfway through a president's four-year term, mainly for Congress.

invasion -- When one country's army enters another country by force.

Background you need

Diesel is a fuel made from crude oil, and it powers most trucks, trains and farm machines, so its price affects the cost of moving and growing almost everything.

When fuel becomes scarce or costly anywhere, prices tend to rise worldwide because oil and fuel are traded globally.

Russia invaded Ukraine, and many countries, including the US and UK, placed sanctions on Russia to limit the money it earns from selling energy.

Buying Russian diesel means easing some of those sanctions, which is why Ukraine and its supporters object.

Break it down

LEAD: Trump announces a deal to import Russian diesel to ease high US fuel prices

KEY EVENT: Putin agrees to release diesel in stages

+ WHO: President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin

+ WHEN: Announced Friday; deliveries now, in November and later

+ HOW: US Treasury issues a temporary license and pauses some sanctions until April 7

BACKGROUND: Fuel prices jumped, which the BBC links to a war involving Iran

EVIDENCE: Expert Tim Armitage says the first delivery is relatively small

REACTION: Zelensky calls it a gift to Putin; the UK keeps supporting Ukraine

OPEN QUESTION: Will the deal actually lower prices at the pump?

Why it matters

Fuel prices affect the cost of food, travel and goods for American families, and the deal also tests how countries balance their own needs against pressure on Russia over its war in Ukraine.

Test what you remember

1. What kind of fuel is the deal about?
 - ☐ (A) Natural gas
 - ☐ (B) Jet fuel
 - ☐ (C) Diesel
 - ☐ (D) Coal
2. How much diesel did Trump say Russia would release right away?
 - ☐ (A) 500,000 tonnes
 - ☐ (B) 300,000 tonnes
 - ☐ (C) Three million tonnes
 - ☐ (D) One million tonnes
3. Until what date is the US Treasury pausing some sanctions?
 - ☐ (A) November 1
 - ☐ (B) January 1
 - ☐ (C) April 7
 - ☐ (D) February 13
4. What did expert Tim Armitage say about the first delivery?
 - ☐ (A) It was the largest fuel deal ever
 - ☐ (B) It would arrive too late
 - ☐ (C) It was relatively small and would not make a big difference at the pump
 - ☐ (D) It would cut prices in half
5. How did Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky describe the deal?
 - ☐ (A) A fair trade
 - ☐ (B) A good deal for Europe
 - ☐ (C) A step toward peace
 - ☐ (D) A gift to Putin
6. According to the BBC, what is linked to the jump in US fuel prices?
 - ☐ (A) A shortage of trucks
 - ☐ (B) A hurricane
 - ☐ (C) A war involving Iran that began in February
 - ☐ (D) New gas taxes

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: C 4: C 5: D 6: C

- 1. President Trump:** Says the deal will bring diesel to the market and help bring down high fuel prices.
- 2. Ukraine's President Zelensky:** Calls the deal a gift to Putin and says such gifts will not work for peace.
- 3. Investment expert Tim Armitage:** Says the amounts are relatively small and calls it a slightly desperate move before the midterms.
- 4. United Kingdom:** Says it will keep pressure on Russia and keep supporting Ukraine.